

Lab 4 Participant Workbook

Teach Copilot your tone of voice, test it against a fixed case and update one rule safely.

200	45-60 minutes	Copilot Chat + Copilot Notebook

DELIVERABLE

A human-approved Tone Profile v1.0, a controlled v1.1 update, a version log and a before-and-after evaluation.

Learning objectives

- derive candidate tone rules from several writing samples;
- separate stable voice from audience-specific tone;
- keep source facts fixed during tone experiments;
- change and validate one tone parameter at a time;
- update Notebook and personal Copilot instructions;
- approve or roll back a tone profile version.

Files required

- Hanna Tone-of-Voice Sample Pack.docx
- Project Atlas Communication Case.docx
- Tone Profile and Change Control Template.docx
- Tone Evaluation and Version Scorecard.xlsx
- Tone-of-Voice Prompt Card.pdf

Exercise 1: Create the baseline

Open the Project Atlas case. Do not open the sample pack yet. Use the baseline prompt and save the complete result in the scorecard.

Baseline prompt

Using the confirmed Project Atlas facts, write an email to the client explaining the UAT update and next steps. Do not add information that is not present in the case.

Review questions

- Is the main update visible in the first two sentences?
- Does it sound generic or overly formal?
- Did Copilot add reassurance, a reason or a commitment?
- Would you send it with minimal editing?

Exercise 2: Discover candidate tone rules

Open the sample pack. Ask Copilot to identify patterns, but do not accept them automatically.

Evidence-based tone analysis

Analyse only the supplied writing samples. For every proposed tone rule, cite two supporting samples, label the rule Consistent or Uncertain, and explain what should not be learned from the examples.

Human promotion gate

Accept	The pattern is supported and intentional.
Edit	The idea is useful but too broad or context-dependent.
Reject	The pattern is not desired or is case-specific.
Insufficient evidence	Fewer than two useful examples support it.

Exercise 3: Build Tone Profile v1.0

Transfer only approved rules into the Tone Profile template. Give every scale a value from 1 to 5.

Profile builder

Using only the human-approved rules, create Tone Profile v1.0. Include voice characteristics, warmth, directness, formality, structure, vocabulary, avoided patterns, action language, uncertainty language and factual safeguards. Do not add unapproved rules.

SUGGESTED STARTING POINT

Warmth 3/5, directness 4/5 and formality 3/5. Participants must confirm these values from the evidence rather than accepting them because they are suggested.

Exercise 4: Configure a Copilot Notebook

- 1 Open Microsoft Copilot and select Notebooks > All notebooks > New notebook.
- 2 Name it Hanna - Consulting Tone of Voice.
- 3 Add the sample pack, Project Atlas case and approved Tone Profile v1.0 as references.
- 4 Select More options (...) > Instructions.
- 5 Paste the approved reusable instruction and select Save.
- 6 Tell the Notebook to use the tone profile as authoritative and the samples only as supporting evidence.

IF NOTEBOOKS IS UNAVAILABLE

Reference the three files directly in Copilot Chat. The experiment still works, but the profile and evidence will not be stored in one scoped workspace.

Exercise 5: Apply and score v1.0

Run the same Project Atlas task inside the configured Notebook. Copy the result into the scorecard.

Apply the profile	
Using the fixed Project Atlas facts and Tone Profile v1.0, draft the client email. Preserve every confirmed fact. Do not invent a promise, reason, owner, deadline, apology or approval. List the tone rules applied.	
Factual fidelity	Are all facts preserved without additions?
Outcome-first	Is the change visible immediately?
Warmth	Is it human without exaggerated friendliness?
Directness	Is the message clear without sounding harsh?
Audience fit	Does it suit an existing client?
Minimal editing	Could the sender use it with small edits?

Exercise 6: Change one parameter

Controlled warmth test
Keep source facts, structure, length, directness and vocabulary unchanged. Change only the warmth of the opening and closing from 2/5 to 3/5. Show the revised email, exact changes and confirmation that no other parameter changed.
DO NOT BUNDLE CHANGES Warm, concise, more professional and persuasive are four separate variables. Test them separately.

Exercise 7: Update the tone profile

Use the supplied stakeholder feedback. Complete the Tone Change Request before editing the profile.

FEEDBACK

The message is clear, but the opening still feels slightly formal for an existing client. Keep the facts, length and directness unchanged. Make only the opening and closing slightly warmer.

- 1 Identify the one rule affected.
- 2 Record parameters that must remain unchanged.
- 3 Create v1.1 while retaining v1.0.
- 4 Update Notebook instructions.
- 5 Repeat the original baseline test.
- 6 Approve, revise or roll back.

Version update

Create Tone Profile v1.1 by applying only the approved change request. Preserve all other v1.0 rules word for word. Return the updated profile, one change-log row, a rollback instruction and a short validation test.

Exercise 8: Update personal custom instructions

- 1 Open Copilot Chat.
- 2 Select Settings and more (...), then Chat settings.
- 3 Select Personalization.
- 4 Find Custom instructions and select Edit instructions.
- 5 Replace the affected rule with the approved v1.1 wording.
- 6 Save the instructions.
- 7 Start a new chat and repeat the Project Atlas test.

SCOPE WARNING

Personal custom instructions can affect future chats. Add only stable personal preferences. Keep project-specific rules in the project Notebook.

Exercise 9: Audience stress test

Keep the core voice and facts fixed. Change one audience dimension at a time.

Audience	Change	Do not change
Existing client	Relationship warmth	Facts, voice identity, purpose
Technical lead	Technical detail	Facts, voice identity, purpose
Executive sponsor	Decision relevance	Facts, voice identity, purpose

Audience-only test

Use the approved tone profile and fixed Project Atlas facts. Change only the audience to [audience]. Adapt detail and terminology without changing the core voice, facts, decision status or next action.

Exercise 10: Final approval

- The same facts were used in baseline, v1.0 and v1.1.
- Only one rule changed between v1.0 and v1.1.
- The change log records the reason and approver.
- No unsupported commitment appears.
- The new version performs at least as well as v1.0.
- A rollback path is documented.

LAB COMPLETE

You created a reusable communication profile, updated it through controlled evidence and retained the ability to explain or reverse the change.

Limitations and responsible use

Limitation	Remedy
Few samples can produce false patterns.	Use several representative examples and human review.
Surface imitation can miss intent.	Test against real communication objectives.
Tone instructions can drift in long chats.	Reference the approved profile and start a new test chat.
Memory is selective and dynamic.	Do not use memory as the only controlled tone source.
Personal voice may not fit legal or crisis messages.	Use specialist review and context-specific rules.
Examples may contain sensitive information.	Use approved, synthetic or redacted samples.

Microsoft documentation

- Customize Copilot responses: <https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365-copilot/customize-how-microsoft-365-copilot-responds-to-you>
- Notebook instructions: <https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365-copilot/provide-custom-instructions-for-your-microsoft-copilot-notebook>
- Evaluate Copilot output: <https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365-copilot/evaluate-copilot-output-for-clarity-accuracy-tone-and-coverage>